

# MAGAZINE TFDW

■ THE  
FUTURE  
DESTINED  
WOMAN  
3RD ISSUE.



## BORN TO BIRTH

YOU ARE BORN TO  
BIRTH, YOU ARE  
BORN TO CREATE  
AND NUTURE.

HOW BEAUTIFUL YOUR  
WORLD WILL BE DE-  
PENDS ON THE MISSION  
YOU EMBARK ON

DO YOU KNOW  
WHAT YOU WHERE  
BORN TO BIRTH

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## SHE IS CALLED BEAUTIFUL.

Before we go into the journey of birthing, let's explain who she is.....  
"Beautiful"

Beautiful is a woman who has a distinctive personality; one who can laugh at anything, one who is especially kind and caring to others. She is a woman, who above all things, knows the value of her place in God and her assignment on earth. She is a woman who you can trust and count on to brighten your day.

According to GEN 12:11, the bible describes Sarah as a beautiful woman. Sarah was the wife of Abraham. a woman who the bible did not only describe her outward beauty but also told stories of her inward beauty. She was barren until the very day God filled her mouth with laughter because of her heart of hospitality and that seed of laughter yielded more great seeds.

"A woman is classified to be beautiful not just with her physical appearance. The make-up she puts on does not make her a beautiful woman, the clothes she wears, do not define her beauty or the perfume she wears. What makes her beautiful is not her look but her inward appearance and the seeds she bears in her.

"A lady that is beautiful is one that you

can trust and rely on. She illuminates her world. She is a lady who can mysteriously make you feel great just by being around her, but then brings such extraordinary mystery of greatness and leaving a blueprint when she is no more".

It was said that Dorcas looked after the widows and made clothes for them. When she died they cried until she was brought back to life. Abraham received some visitors on some occasion, Sarah as the wife of Abraham entertained these strangers just as her husband did. She did the cooking as a wife. She did not quarrel or argue with her husband on "why he received the strangers" or "why she will cook for the strangers". Indeed, she welcomed them as the husband did and was hospitable to them. As a woman, what makes you beautiful is not your outward appearance but your inside beauty just as Sarah was hospitable.

"It's not about the clothing, the hair, the make-up. It's all about the way she warms the world with her heart.

We are in a world where everyone wants to be seen and recognized. Every girl wants to be beautiful and to be seen. Most girls go as far as going for surgery (breast enlargement, hip enlargement, lip enlargement, face lifting, and so on) thinking that it is all beauty.

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No critics, the truth is that doesn't define your beauty. Have you ever wondered what will happen when we return back to the soil? What exactly will be our remark, our blueprint, and the story to be told. what will people remember you for, what kind of color did you use to beautify the environment when you were close by. Did your beauty ever reflect in their lives? Is it all called beauty when you struggle to get money for the latest cosmetics, the latest shoes, and clothes just to be like others? Do you fail to understand the meaning of "beautiful" when you only define your outward self? You are called beautiful because you are created to create a beautiful world.

**YOU ARE BORN TO  
BIRTH, YOU ARE  
BORN TO CREATEE  
AND NUTURE.**

I pray for a spiritual and physical understanding as we go through these writings on your creation to birthing in Jesus' name. Amen.

# BORN TO BIRTH (PART 1)

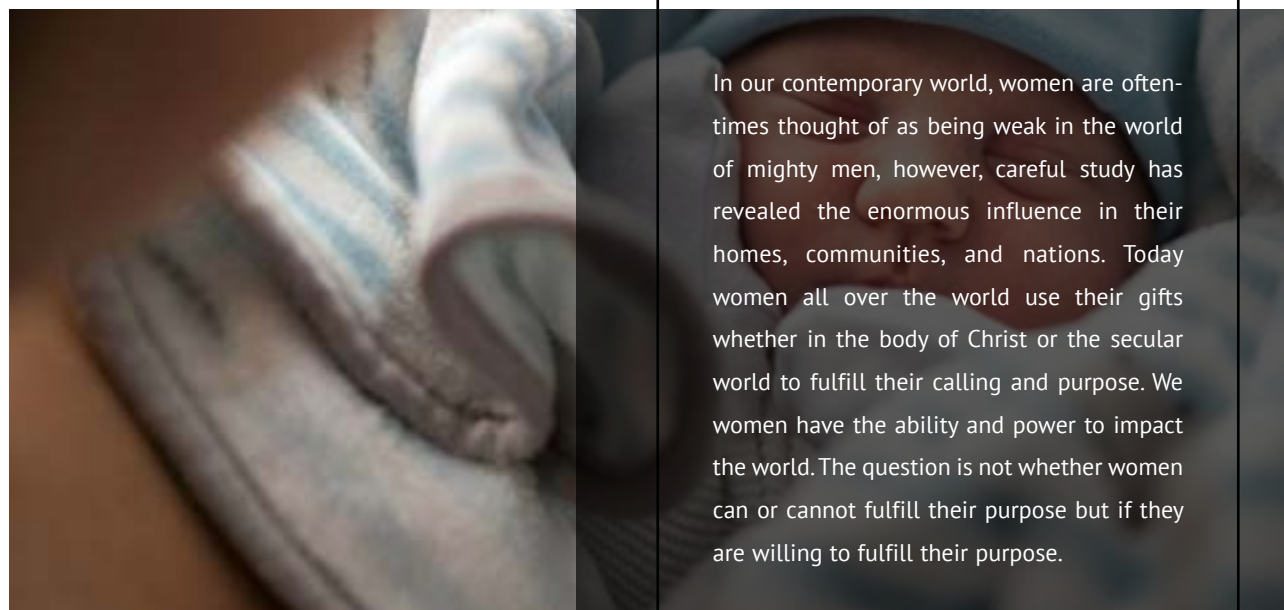


To birth means to bring forth, to give life, to produce something tangible and worthwhile. God places special value on every one of us, especially us women. This automatically means you are born for a purpose (something so great that is beyond your imagination), you have a purpose-driven life that can affect the lives of others. As individuals who are “born to birth”, our lives are expected to model, mentor, and shape things around us for good. That is the true essence of birthing. In other words, being Born to birth can be likened to fulfill a purpose. The word purpose can be understood as the reason for being on earth or for why we were created. The thought that everyone has been assigned a unique purpose in life is truly amazing. What this means is that no one is worthless. As women, we constantly need to ask ourselves these questions “what on earth I’m I here for?”, “why do I exist?”, “what are God’s intentions for my life?”. Sometimes the process

of discovering purpose can be daunting but worthwhile if discovered. A life of purpose is fulfilling and rewarding. The bible records some women who discovered and walk in their purpose. The bible gives an account of many of these women but the emphasis will be made on just two of them – Deborah and Esther.

Deborah was a wife, a prophet, a counselor, and a judge in Israel. She was an instrument God used to deliver the Israelites from their enemies. Barak insisted she goes with them to the battlefield or else he wouldn’t go. Long before Deborah exercised her uncommon leadership skills, she was a homemaker and a mother in Israel. So Woman, what has God told you to do? Discover it and focus on it and He will give you the grace to accomplish it.

Esther’s purpose was to purposefully deliver the Jews. She was used by God to



## OTHER WOMEN LIKE RAHAB, RUTH, ABIGAIL, AND JAEAL ALSO FULFILLED THEIR PURPOSE.

In our contemporary world, women are often-times thought of as being weak in the world of mighty men, however, careful study has revealed the enormous influence in their homes, communities, and nations. Today women all over the world use their gifts whether in the body of Christ or the secular world to fulfill their calling and purpose. We women have the ability and power to impact the world. The question is not whether women can or cannot fulfill their purpose but if they are willing to fulfill their purpose.

Since we have come to understand what purpose is and how important it is to fulfill the purpose, let’s dive into how it can be cultivated. As I’ve earlier stated, purpose can be daunting and can feel overwhelming (nobody says it’s an easy task especially when you try to do it on your own or rely on your strength. Here are a few tips to help you discover and fulfill your purpose and sis, it doesn’t have to be overwhelming and scary.

### TIP 1: ASK GOD TO REVEAL YOUR PURPOSE

If you have already discovered your purpose that’s awesome!! If you haven’t, there’s no need to be discouraged regardless of whatever age you are. The good news is that while God wants us to fulfill purpose, He doesn’t just abandon us to discover it alone. The answer lies in going to God to reveal it to us. Some bible scriptures support this:

“Many are the plans in the mind of a man, but it is the purpose of the Lord that will stand.  
Proverbs 19:21”

“The Lord will fulfill his purpose for me; your steadfast love, O Lord, endures forever. Do not forsake the work of your hands.  
Psalm 138:82”

### TIP 2: LET HIM EQUIP YOU

After God has revealed your purpose to you, ask him to equip you. When God equips you, it takes the pressure off of you. The part you need play is to rely on Him. Rather than stress about fulfilling your purpose let Him equip you.

“I cry out to God Most High, to God who fulfills his purpose for me.  
Psalm 57:2”



### TIP 3: STAY IN HIS PRESENCE

You do this by studying the scriptures (there are many scriptures to encourage you), praying constantly, and obeying Him. In conclusion, I want us to determine in our hearts to be women of purpose, to be willing to be purposeful in all that we do. To seek God, pray, and meditate on His word for directions and help. Rely on Him totally to help you, speak and listen to Him because hearing from God enhances your purpose. As we walk in our God-given purpose, may He grant us a blessed and fulfilled life in Jesus’s Name, Amen!!

WRITTEN BY EZE ESTHER.

# ARE YOU BRANDED?

In organizational terms, Branding is the act of combining features such as a logo, design, mission statement, and a consistent theme throughout all marketing communications to create a strong, favorable perception of a company, its products, or services in the minds of customers. Your brand is a representative of your company. Bringing it down to our being, a brand is a representative of yourself.

Your brand defines who you are. It is the exhibition of what you think, what you say, and what you do. That means it is the image of yourself. One can understand her brand when she realizes who she is. Understanding who you are matters a lot before you can become that person you want to be. A lot of persons live to become another being. Some live in another person's dream which at the end of the day, they feel so dissatisfied with themselves because they were not self-actualized.

When the angel of God appeared to Mary, the angel gave Mary an uncommon greeting (Luke 1: 28) "And the angel being come in, said unto her: Hail, full of grace, the Lord is with thee: blessed art thou among women". KJV said thou art highly favored. The angel who is a messenger of God was sent to Mary to deliver a message to her but the angel could not just deliver the message without not acknowledging who she is. Hail Mary full of grace, in this greeting you could see that it was an uncommon greeting.

She was recognized by heaven, favored to be the mother of the savior. The angel continued by saying blessed are you among women, this reviewed to her that she is an exception. At this point, I'm sure Mary will be wondering what she did to deserve this kind of heavenly greeting. The truth about this is that Mary didn't understand her existence until the visitation of the angel sent by GOD. That Visitation gave her a new name as the mother of Jesus. I can remember the very day I walked into my rich friend, we had some conversations about life in general, at the end of our discussion he said to me "I have everything but I still feel empty and dissatisfied with life, in fact, I don't know why I'm living, nothing interests me in this life". It quickly ran through my mind that money does not define you. He had money but was not fulfilled. He had money but feels empty. Yes, Money is good. Money is part of an instrument to carry out your mission as a person and it does not make you who you are. It does not brand you. What brands do you have? God's definition of your life: For one to be branded, you have to find your definition of who you are from the one who created you. Mary didn't know how highly favored and blessed she is until the angel of God visited her. Have you ever heard about the story of the woman at the well in John chapter 4?



Who ARE You?



## NOBODY HEARD ABOUT HER UNTIL SHE HAD AN ENCOUNTERED WITH JESUS.

Nobody knew her story, nobody heard about her until she had an encounter with Jesus. Her encounter with Jesus gave her a meaningful life. Before her encounter with Jesus, she felt that she was worthless because she found herself living in a world where women are devalued and ignored, in a race that Jews have historically detested, and living in shame as a social outcast. Until Jesus met her. He unveiled who she was and still asked to drink from her cup. That encounter made the world to know her great story, that encounter gave her a new name and a new brand, instead of recognizing her as the widow with five husbands, we now know her as the Samaritan woman at the well. Just as prophet Jeremiah encountered God who made him understand who He created him to be before he began to manifest as prophet Jeremiah. You cannot understand or define who you are until you have an encounter with the one who created you. At this point he gives you a mission.

## UNDERSTAND YOUR MISSION AND EMBARK ON IT:

We know food as food and we understand that the reason why we eat is to satisfy our hunger. When God created Adam he named him Adam as the first man He created on earth and gave him a mission to name the things He created, a mission to be fruitful and multiply the earth. To every man God created on earth, He gave a mission to carry out. You are not called just to live. You are called to give life meaning. Before the creation, bible recorded that the earth was without shape, it was not beautiful. It was just known as earth but there was no existence until God embarked on the mission of creation.

We could see that at the end of creation God became satisfied with what he created because it was beautiful. God is called THE CREATOR because He created everything, He embarked on a mission that gave Him a name as the Creator. Embarking on your mission gives you a brand that satisfies you at the end of your accomplishment.



How beautiful your world will become depends on the mission you embarked on and your mission is given when you have an encounter with your creator who gives you the definition of who you are.

You are not here on earth to be Bill gate, you are not here to become your pastor, you are not here to become your parents or love ones, you are here to become who God said you will be. Never you allow the world to define you, define the world that you are given. Find yourself in Him and understand yourself in Him for eyes have not seen, ears have not heard, neither has it enter into the heart of man, what God has prepared for them that loves Him. You are the next creator. what has God place in your hand to create? and what is your brand?



# DO YOU KNOW WHAT YOU WERE BORN TO BIRTH?

Are you aware that, you were carefully knitted, created and crafted for a reason? Born by His purpose, and for His purpose. This also means born IN PURPOSE and FOR PURPOSE. For you to even be born at all, it means, there is something you were BORN to BIRTH So, you can't be alive and not know why, you have been given life. This is because, everything got started with Him and finds its purpose in Him- Col 1:16.

From the scripture, we can see where the above statement was extracted. Also, Jer 1:4 points us clearly to this. Friend, it means beyond discovering your purpose, you must stay attuned for life in same purpose, for your life to gain expression and shine greatly. Hence, it doesn't end in receiving the gift of salvation. Let's look at Saul's encounter quickly to understand this. After Saul's encounter (he trembled and was astonished) hence asked, what will thou have me do? Acts 9:6. The question is, have you known what He will have you do? A reminder came for me some time back from the scripture as relates Eve. It is not good for man to be alone, so Eve came to make it good. Just like the Lord said and purposed for Eve, there is "something not good", you were born to solve. Check your environment, is there something 'you feel not good about'? you are there to make it good.

Meanwhile, it is important to note that purpose cuts across every area of our life. Business, workplace, school, home, church etc. Looking at it in the context of business, because people sideline this aspect.

If you don't start with your "why-purpose" before going into business, when challenges come up, you won't have something to not make you not give up. For instance, Mark Zuckerberg, the founder of Facebook had a "why" from the beginning.

His "why" was, I want to be able to connect people all over the world, from the comfort of their homes. And, look at where Facebook is today. Isn't that amazing? Another example is, Orville and Wilbur's (founders of aircraft) their why was to be able to create an aircraft that would be able to fly far distances without interruption. Today, we have a flying aircraft. But, this why kept them going amidst challenges. What is your why? Today, talk of the wright brothers, the world would be on a standing ovation.





## WHAT YOUR WHY DOES?

### YOUR WHY SPONSORS-

- 1) WHAT YOU DO
- 2) HOW YOU DO IT
- 3) WHEN YOU DO IT
- 4) WHERE YOU DO IT

And, remember that, what you do is a direct proof to what you believe.

### BIG QUESTION:

So, why do you get up every morning?  
Why do you leave your house every day?

Now, it is this understanding, that will spur you to be the light you are meant to be...

Meanwhile, have you ever wondered why each person is different in appearance and character etc. One unconventional reason is, just an individual can't save the world. Everyone has been made differently and has a role to play (purpose to fulfill). So, no one is ever permitted to feel, or think for one

day that his/her role looks small. You were BORN to BIRTH.

That seemingly small thing, is that which is capable enough to birth a seed that will spring forth nations.

But, have you realized a connection to note? this connection is between purpose and emotional intelligence?

If one can identify his/her purpose, it is much easier to determine what type of emotional reactions will serve their purpose, and that which will defeat it.

For instance, if your role(purpose) involves talking to people daily, empathy would not be left out. Some persons paid for a class which I wasn't the only one championing it, so we had little lapses, hence a delay on when the class was supposed to begin, he reached out to us angrily, and what made the difference was how I was able to accept our failure, apologies and explain current situation. We got recommendations from this person, just by this seemingly simple act.

Also, if you don't have a reason for waking up daily (purpose fulfillment), why should you bother learning how to understand people's feelings per time(empathy)? Do you now see how they go hand-in-hand? In addition, it has been largely discovered that, "your role"(purpose) makes you more biological resilient, so you may wonder where this inner strength comes from despite any resistance, that should bring you emotionally down.

It is hinged on an alignment to purpose, I had mentioned the brain interpreting your role(purpose) as "fun" because of the satisfaction it distinctively brings, or should bring.

So, when you are taking a step daily to achieving your role, the fun interpreted spurs you to enjoying what you are doing despite oppositions/challenges bent on causing a resistance.

And, you know what? RESILIENCE negates RESISTANCE. This means continuity in exerting your role, showing up strong, and consequently leading to a life of impact and fulfillment. Isn't that amazing? Are you experiencing this already? You want to understand the discovery aspect of purpose specifically? You can reach out.

I am rooting for you always. I toast to your emotional growth.

Much Love!  
Compassion©



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# Anne's KITCHEN

- African Delicacies
- Small chops
- Birthday cakes
- Fish and Chicken barbecue
- Cocktails
- Indoor and Outdoor Catering services

# BORN TO BIRTH: PART 2

Ever since I was a child I always knew I was destined for greatness. It wasn't until recently I realized that this greatness wouldn't simply come from the external impact of my actions and accomplishments, but mainly, through the internal transformation of my heart.



For years, I sought external validation for who I was, who I was becoming, and who I needed to be. From looking to my father to show his approval for the career I had chosen, to looking to friends and romantic partners to applaud my numerous life choices.

I soon came to understand how deeply exhausting the place of external validation is. It robs you of your own voice and of the power rooted within you to be. It's puts at the forefront, the idea that it is others, who by their approval of you, deposit greatness within you. It silences the real truth, that you were born great from the beginning.

To me, born to birth means born to create, to challenge, and to transform. It means recognizing that ingrained within us all is the power, ability, and means to create beauty, wonder, and hope in this world. That birth process starts the day you realize that with God "you are enough!"

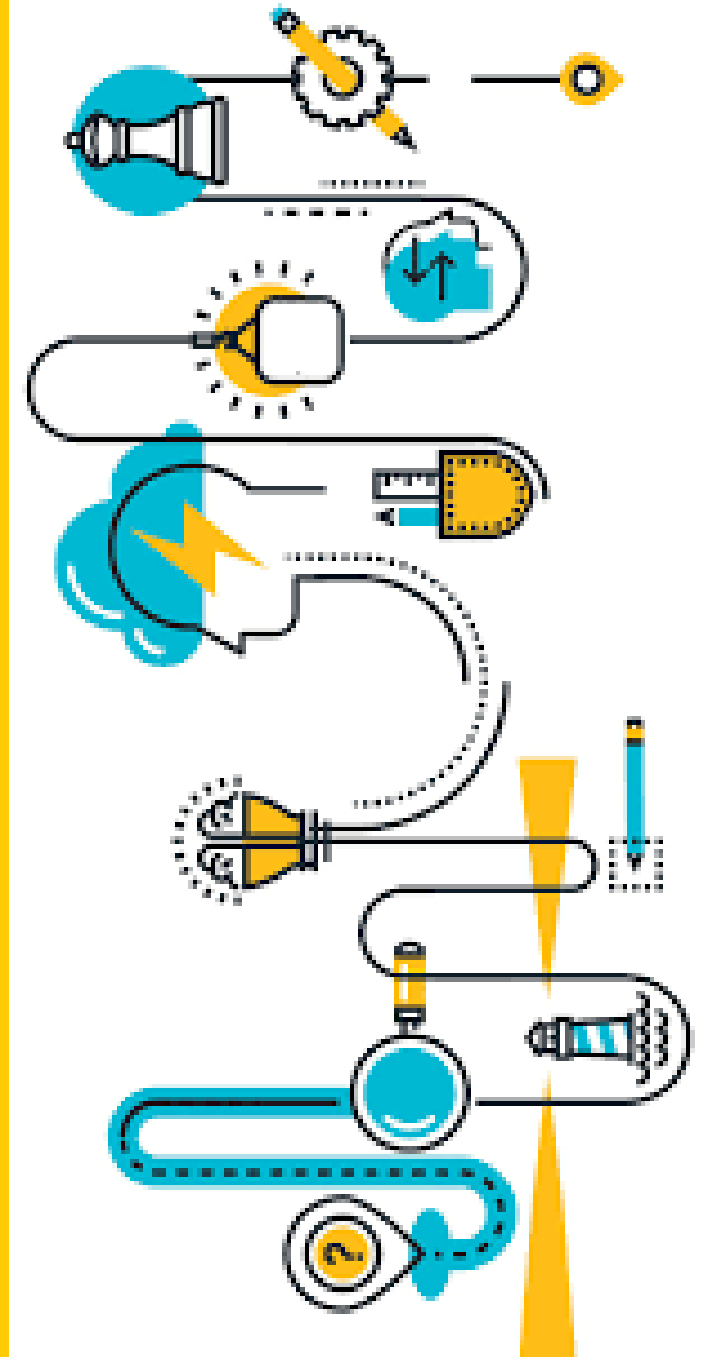
Written by (Tejiri Odjighoro)

## EMBRACE THE PROCESS

Embrace your life  
Embrace every gift given to you by the Creator.  
Embrace every phase of life you face.  
Embrace your love ones,  
Your family, friends and companions.  
Certainly Life gave you the best of best.

Embrace your pains  
They sharpen you to become YOU.  
It makes you become stronger and brave.  
Enlightened you to be positive.  
The pain of labor yield to  
The beautiful story of motherhood.  
Life is beautiful but not always sweet.  
It can be sour,  
Giving you that bitter sweet taste.

Embrace your flaws  
They make you human and natural.  
By embracing you learn to be grateful.



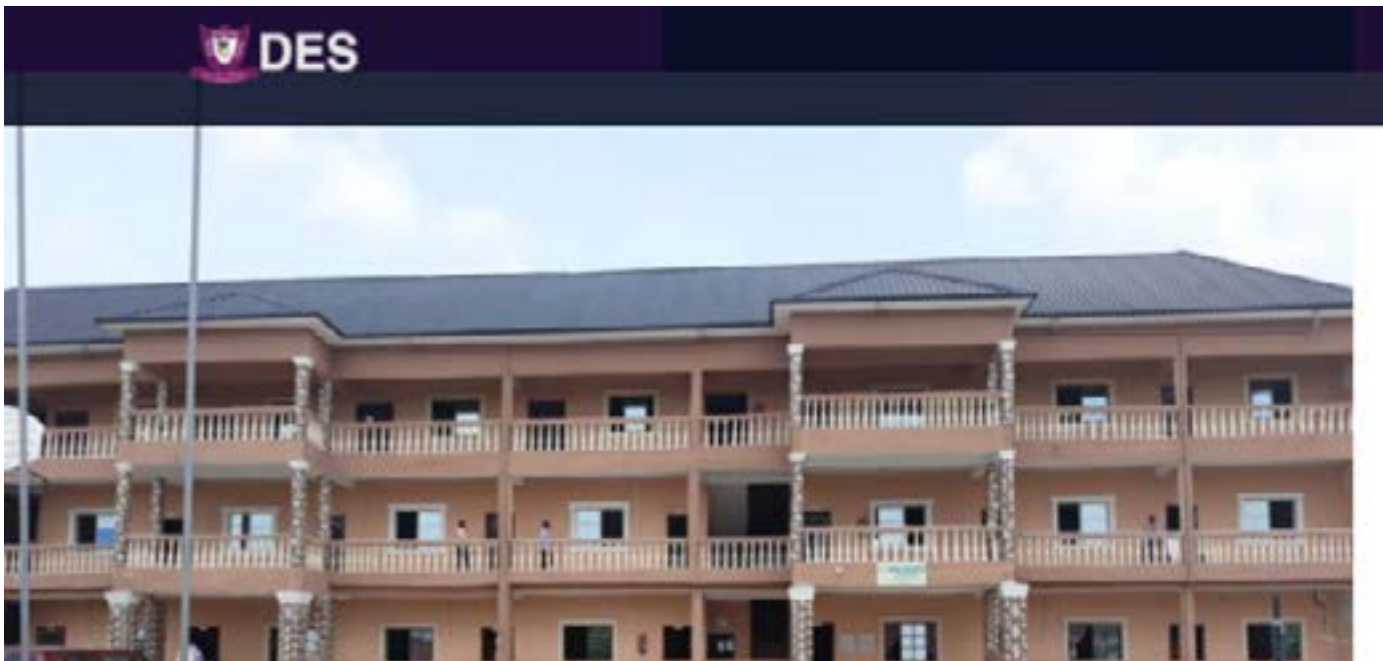


## About us

Divine Encounter Nursery and Primary School, Established in 2014. The goal is to Enhance the inner potential in every student. Thanks to our commitment to excellence, we have been able to remain true to our motto "Wisdom and Knowledge".

Indeed every student in Divine Encounter Nursery and Primary School, is equipped and positioned to become a leader. Through our value systems, we consistently ensure that every imbibes the culture of the distinction.

*We are a school that is passionate about feeding young minds*



# WE ENSURE BETTER EDUCATION FOR A BETTER WORLD

### Government Approved

The government is aware of our vision which is one of the fundamental reason we can obtain a licence and operate.

### Certified Teachers

Our teachers are experienced, certified and tested wordy of passing the right knowledge required for your kids to excel.

### Creative Lessons

Our learning syllabus is world-class, and also government approved. We also provide after school lessons to make sure they learn beyond what we teach in

### Regular Classes

We provide spacious, well-equipped state of the art classrooms and labs, which are very conducive for day to day learning.

### School Bus

For those who live far, or can not afford to drop their wards at school, we provide good school buses and trained drivers to do that.

### Sports Facilities

We provide spacious sporting field and equipment for the mental and healthy growth of our students.



# PICK UP YOUR SHACKLES

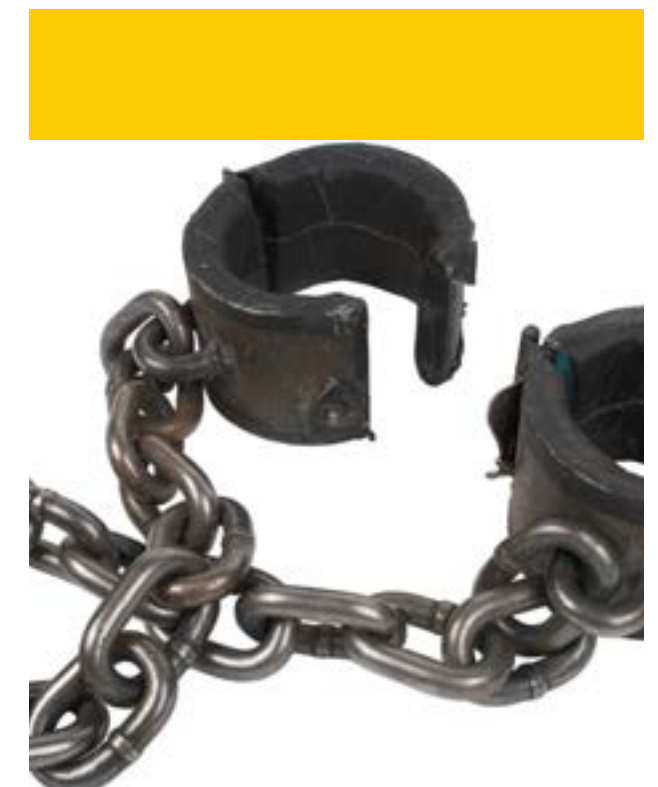
Sometimes, it does not all go the way we plan it. At that young age, we saw ourselves with that bright dreams of becoming great, to some an accountant, a banker, a doctor, an engineer. Then growing up to take full responsibilities of ourselves. Early morning, we dash out to our various place of work to make our ends meal and paying for our bills. Being accountable for ourselves, pursing our daily struggle, we begin to forget those dreams of who we envisioned to became when we grow. In those dreams, we never saw life heating us so hard. Among the struggles of life, we encounter exposure, brokenness, sorrows, pain and become more knowledgeable about life. It does not go all rosy. We are not in the world we fantasized about when we were little.

Life becomes a puzzle. Life becomes a puzzle. In the midst of solving this puzzle to survive, some give up along the line. Because they feel neglected and rejected. They give up on finding the answers to the puzzle of life place in them. Instead, they try to find the fastest means to survive out of ignorance and negativity. I can no longer make it, I

can no longer become a doctor or that person I dreamt to be. Life becomes a tragedy for them because they find it so hard to keep believing on who they are and who they are called to be.

Your dreams can become alive only when you stop dreaming and start living in that dream. Let your dream be alive. It can be so hard to live in that dream but in that dream you can find your strength and ability to keep them alive. In that rejected dream your light can shine. It's all too simple to give up when something becomes too difficult. Giving up your dream isn't the best choice; instead, try starting all over. It's possible that you're dissatisfied with your life. The most common blunder, on the other hand, is giving up.

A person grows stronger and more well-rounded as a result of their perseverance in the face of hardship. When things are tough, don't give in to the temptation to take the easy way out. If you keep pushing forward, you could just surprise yourself. There is no greater satisfaction than overcoming adversity and emerging victorious. So pick up your shackles today and start afresh. In that brokenness find strength. In that hatred find love. In that pain, refine it and mold it out to become something beautiful. The world is waiting to see the new you.



# AN UNDENIABLE EXCHANGE TO BIRTHING



There are many things in this world that humans exchange between each other. Infact, our entire lives are filled with several forms of exchanges. An adage popularly spoken is "no man is an Island". This implies that humans need each other in almost anything to be done at all. Just imagine a world without communication which is the most basic form of exchange of feelings or ideas to others.

We exchange money between ourselves daily and we call it "spending". We offer ourselves services in exchange for money. The most common form of exchange is between countries where resources are being exchanged for other resources or for money. Here in Nigeria, crude oil is being exchanged for refined petroleum products such as bitumen, kerosene etc.

THERE IS A DEEPER FORM OF EXCHANGE, HOWEVER EXPERIENCED BY COUPLES OR LOVERS AS THE CASE MAY BE. IT IS CALLED SEXUAL INTERCOURSE OR SIMPLY SEX.

Sex is necessary for the existence of man and for life on earth to continue, but is this the only value of this most intimate form of exchange? A lot more than we think happens during sexual intercourse. For example, there is a popular believe among teenagers or youths believe that sex enhances love in a relationship, making lovers to find excuses for their sexual adventures.

Whether this is true or not, it's not the factor, but this suggests that something "emotional" is attached to sex. It is believed that prostitutes have a "form of behavior" typical to them. They could put up such because of the nature of their jobs or because of the nature of their customers, one does not know. But a typical experience among spiritualists has revealed that sex is used as a tool for deep exchange that has a demonic portfolio embedded whether physically or in a dream.

Many reasons may exist for such. One of such is that blood is being exchanged during intercourse. Blood which contains life is believed to be an important medium in the spirit realm for spiritual transactions, and when blood is taken of anyone, life ceases to exist.



# IN THE CHRISTIAN WORLD

The Bible lays emphasis on the strong bond that exists between sexual partners. (1 Corinthians 6). Here in Africa, it is not foreign to hear of damsels contracting strange incurable illnesses, being turned into strange animals, or mad women from sexual contact with men who may have been mystical. This has been proven severally. Individuals who perform exorcism testify that many of their patients are either prostitutes, or keep multiple sexual partners. This is maybe because of the spiritual exchanges occurring during intercourse. often women, have acknowledged using their bodies as a tool to obtain several favors. Many have gotten good contracts, promotions or highly sougled offers in exchange for

sexual pleasures with those who control such opportunities. Several others have lured lecturers in high institutions into affairs with them in exchange for good academic grades. Even men have been made severally to exchange their sexuality for favors. I apologize for writing this way, but this is what we see in this part of the world where we come from. As our society keeps degrading morally, sex will always be undeniably a tool for exchange.

Men have sacrificed their genitals to acquire spiritual powers or most commonly wealth. We could go and on, but not to miss out of the purpose of this write-up in the process...

In the Catholic Church, Priests are seen as saints because they have consecrated themselves to God by sacrificing their sexualities.

Dear woman, you have been bought with a prize, so your bodies must explicitly glorify God, as it is His temple and has made you a custodian



of it here on earth so that you can even through it show Him forth. This is why the word used, "know yet not", it could also mean "don't you know"? Now, having known, what are you doing about it? If eventually, a mistake has been made. It's not yet late, you can still let your light shine, refrain from any form of self-condemnations, because you are saved, loved and healed. Yet, be ready to take a better walk.

My lady, the guy that demands for sex, and still say I love you is that one love? smiles. He loves you when he rather says, I love you so much that I won't like to hurt you; we would have and enjoy sex after marriage.

My guy, please don't allow those physical curves you keep seeing in ladies build bridges in your heart, that it becomes your basics for a choice and as well make you want to have sex. Remember he that hooks up with a harlot exchanges his spirit. Inevitably, there is something special about sex, and that is why, it has to be the bait for many sacrifices and exchange.

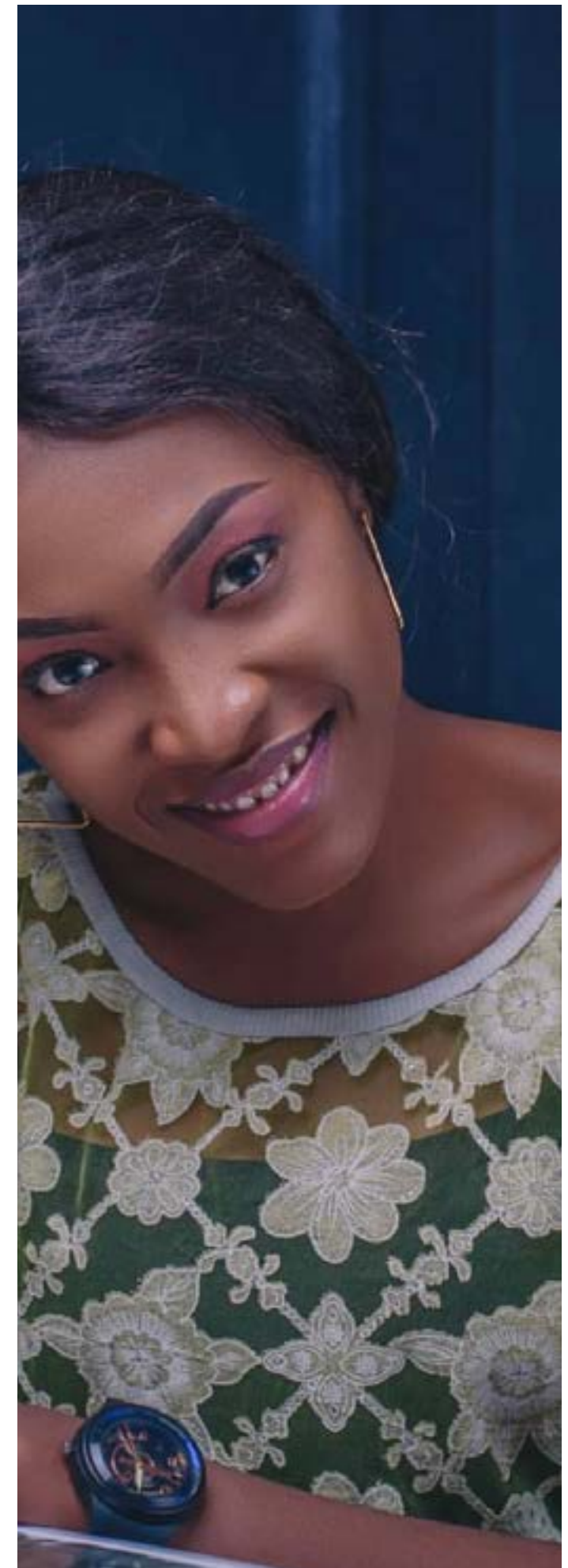
Be rest assured that, no exchange done outside marriage via sex produces good fruits, hence It is an **UNDENIABLE EXCHANGE** to **BIRTHING**, which is fulfilling purpose. The best exchange needed for birthing at this point is, your life for His. **WOMAN**, you are a **WOW MAN**, this is why you are seen this way.

W-What  
O-Our  
M-Men  
A-Are  
N-Not

Isn't that amazing? Remember, he that "WAITS" receives the **CROWN** of life, and you are a crown of life.

Much Love!

**Praise Akobo.**



# A LITTLE THIRST OF IT.



It looks so bright, stylish and enticing. It's absolutely the modern day life style and everyone is cool with it, why not grow up and trend with it since we are in 21st century. I'm not ancient and won't be odd among my friends. "Let's go clubbing" they said, it's ok to go after all I won't do anything wrong, I said to myself. "Let's drink" I don't drink but yea, I'm cool to have a little taste of it. I don't post my half naked pictures on social media but it's ok if my friends post them since it's not on my page. Little by little I saw myself getting the taste of everything I didn't want in life. I no longer feel that innocence in me because I really want to enjoy the moment. fermentum purus sit amet enim fermentum posuere odio sapien elementum justo. Donec sollicitudin

lacus turpis, ac finibus diam interdum.

At this point of my life, I want to feel good and happy. Being around my friends helps me feel among, without hearing the cry of the innocent girl in me. Oh no I'm pregnant. Am I just realizing it now or was the time faster than I imagined? Did I finally lose the innocent girl in me or is the world crumbling at my feet? I can't even tell what is happening on my inside any longer.

I was only trying to fit into the society and impress my friends. I didn't mean hurt to my innocence. I didn't know it will get to this phase where I will be lost. I can longer go after those dreams I had with this child inside me because I have to fetch for its

wellbeing. No parents to hold unto because I chose this path on my own. My down fall began the very day I started having a little taste of it.

I'm not against you having your young age to the fullest, I'm not against you going for those parties and having fun time with your friends, but I'm against



you going against your will in order to fit into the society. It's natural for a young person just starting out in their career to want to get along with their peers. It can be discouraging to learn that some of them simply despise you, and you'll find yourself bending to their demands. This is a significant mistake. Because there isn't a formula that guarantees that everyone will like you. Many young people expressed a strong desire to travel back in time to their "even younger" years, which was a shocking discovery. Most remembered their college years as a period of mingling, drinking, and "experiencing the fringes of life," as one put it. In recollection, many people saw this period as a period of wasted setup time.

Knowing what they know today, there was a feeling that many of them would use their college years as a springboard for something other than what they were doing now. Your neglects to prepare for what the future holds for you, gives you a return of regret. Your youthful age is a time of learning. You don't necessary have to belong, you do not have to fit into the society for you to be happy. The likes of society should not define who you are and you do not have to impress anyone to be you.

This young generation see the world of what it is now and not tomorrow. We fail to understand that the future we imagine, is the life we prepared today. A little taste gradually grew to become a lifestyle; it can lead you to a life that you cannot amend or return. The hand of a clock cannot tick backward. Be mindful of the decision you make, the lifestyle you choose today and be cautious of the path you trend on.






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(CHRISTIANA)

# ON MY 25TH BIRTHDAY

Adanne! Adanne! the voice calling me sounded like a faraway whisper. I woke with a start, thinking it was a dream. Adanne! Adanne! This time around the banging on the door was distinctively clear. I scrambled to my feet, grabbed the robe I found lying on the chair close to the bed and hurried to open the door.

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'So I have to scream at the top of my lungs for the entire neighborhood to hear before you can let your mother in eh?'

I just stood at the doorway in complete shock. How on earth did she find her way to my place? Was there a problem? Luckily I found my words and tried to use them

'Mama Nne. Come in'

She quickly pushed me aside

without a word and bounded into the house, annoyance clearly written all over her face. The living room was a complete mess from the night before. The bottles of alcohol were still scattered on the floor and one of the chairs was facing downwards. It had been a wild party with the girls to celebrate my 25th birthday. With that knowledge came a nagging pain. I have not yet accomplished my goals and it was obvious that time was indeed running out for me.

My mother being who she was, didn't miss a hint of the events of the previous night but to my amazement, she never uttered a word. She simply waded through all the chaos and found a spot to

sit. When she had sat down, she folded her arms across her chest and looked at me straight in the face. 'My daughter'. She began. 'I have not come here to lecture you as I usually do. You are a grown woman and you can make decisions for yourself. However, you know that you are my only child. I have come to ask you when you will be bringing a man home to see your father and I? It is high time you take that step and give your father and I grandchildren. I was not surprised. In fact, I had been expecting this nagging question but I did not expect the rush of pain. There was also anger. I knew I was an only child, gotten after such a long search and after years of marriage. But did that

also mean that I had also given up my right to a happy life? Did it mean that it has become my sole responsibility to promote the lineage of my family? What about my dreams? I was only 25 years old. What about my ambitions? I had held it in for too long and I could no longer keep mute. 'Mom I do not intend to get married anytime soon', the words came tumbling out. The expression on my mother's face was one of complete amusement at first, then as quickly it changed to utter annoyance. 'What did you say? I am not sure I heard you correctly'. Now she was on her feet.

# AS QUICKLY AS SHE HAD STOOD UP

she sat back and folded her arms across her breasts. Then the flood of tears began. I knew I had lost this round of the fight. I had always hated to see my mother cry. It hurt too deep. I ran to her, hugged her and tried to quiet her. She would never understand. Why can't they understand that there was more to being a woman than the need to bear sons. Why couldn't she understand that I wanted to become something, somebody.

This need to gain validation was often the cry of so many young women. Society in past times had made it a woman's place to be seen and not heard.

A property to be admired, a commodity. In recent times the women folk have begun to take a stand. Women are breaking out and speaking up. Not just with words, but by deliberate actions. Women are owners of multinational companies, they are CEOs, they are in politics, they are making waves.

I never could bring myself to understand my family's quest for my immediate marriage. Not that I had anything against it, but I wanted more. I wanted to be an independent woman, who would be able to contribute meaningfully to her home and society whenever it was needed. I wanted to prove

that a girl child had more to offer.

The tears quickly dried up as soon as they had begun, but this time around there was a gentle softness and calm. Mother looked me straight in the eyes while she spoke. 'I used to have those same dreams a long ago before you were born.



I wanted more out of life too. But I never got the opportunity. I was made to believe that a woman had very little to offer to her community and sadly I am also trying to instill the same notion to you. Somehow I have allowed my desperation to rub me of reasoning and I am very sorry for that....'

I could not believe the sudden transformation. Did I just hear correctly or was it a dream?

She was aware of my surprise and simply smiled

'My daughter, you are all I have and I want you to be happy. I will stand by your decision and support you... your father and I, but I will also expect that you do not disappoint me'. I quickly threw my arms around her in a warm embrace.

'Thank you mom!' I was beaming with joy. Deep down I knew I was going to make this woman very proud.





BY JACINTA

## BORN TO BIRTH: PART 3

# HOW TO BIRTH GREAT DESTINIES AND LEAVE A MARK

As a woman, knowing your identity and purpose is crucial, not only for your destiny and walk with God but also in leaving a mark at the end of the road before returning to our ABBA in glory. To understand these, we need to go to the beginning where it all started. Genesis 1:26 tells us of how God created us in His image and after His likeness and therefore the only place we can ever really find our identity is in Him. Identity is such an indispensable aspect that pertains to the life of any individual because it gives one the sense of being and feeling known. To elaborate, many of us search for our identity in the titles and

names we acquire or can make for ourselves, beauty, careers to mention but a few. You see the danger in this is that when we fail to get these titles as expected, whether it is being a financially established career woman, wife and mother before 30 or the first woman to do this or that, many of us fall into a downward spiral of loss and grief feeling like we aren't "enough of a woman" as we should be. Don't get me wrong, all these are great ambitions and dreams but we shouldn't let them be the standards we set to define us. We need to accept that our identity is defined by God alone and that when He marvelously

designed us in the dark of our mother's womb, He did so with intentionality and with a purpose in mind and that before we are even born like Jeremiah, He had already called us and marked us for His glory.

"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, before you were born I set you apart;

I appointed you as a prophet to the nations."

- Jeremiah 1:5-



Jeremiah was a prophet before he was even born and John the Baptist was already the forerunner for Jesus and His ministry even before he was conceived.

But the angel said to him: "Do not be afraid, Zechariah; your prayer has been heard. Your wife Elizabeth will bear you a son, and you are to call him John. He will be a joy and delight to you, and many will rejoice because of his birth, 15 for he will be great in the sight of the Lord. He is never to take wine or other fermented drink, and he will be filled with the Holy Spirit even before he is born.

He will bring back many of the people of Israel to the Lord their God. 17 And he will go on before the Lord, in the spirit and power of Elijah, to turn the hearts of the parents to their children and the disobedient to the wisdom of the righteous—to make ready a people prepared for the Lord." -Luke 1:13-17.

So you see whatever it is that God designed you for and called you too can only be defined by Him and to know what that is, we need to walk with Him closely every single moment of every day so He can lead us into it in His timing.

When we are aligned into what God has anointed and appointed us for, we are then able to plant good seeds and bear lasting fruit in our

generation. Consider Esther, a young Jewish girl turned queen when her people were deported to Persia, a foreign kingdom, and were living in exile. At the appointed time, she was able to bring about the salvation of her people who were all going to be killed because of the pride of one official, Haman.

When Haman saw that Mordecai would not bow down or show him respect, he was filled with rage. He had learned of Mordecai's nationality, so he decided it was not enough to lay hands on Mordecai alone.

Instead, he looked for a way to destroy all the Jews throughout the entire empire of Xerxes. -Esther 3:5-65  
Esther said, "If it pleases the king, and if I have found favor with him, and if

he thinks it is right, and if I am pleasing to him, let there be a decree that reverses the orders of Haman son of Hammedatha the Agagite, who ordered that Jews throughout all the king's provinces should be destroyed. 6 For how can I endure to see my people and my family slaughtered and destroyed?" The king's decree gave the Jews in every city authority to unite to defend their lives. They were allowed to kill, slaughter, and annihilate anyone of any nationality or province who might attack them or their children and wives and to take the property of their enemies.

The Jews were filled with joy and gladness and were honored everywhere. In every province and city, wherever the king's decree arrived, the Jews rejoiced and had a great celebration and declared a public festival and holiday.

-Esther 7:5-6, 11, 16-17-

Hannah, Ruth and the virgin Mary are other women in the Bible who at the appointed time were able to walk into their God-given callings and assignments due to their deep reverence and love for God. They gave birth to children that lived to fulfil God's purpose. Hannah bore one of the greatest prophets of the old testament while Ruth's future generation was blessed with not only some of the mightiest kings of Israel but with the Lord Jesus Christ who was born by the Virgin Mary centuries later.

It is therefore plain to see what God can do with us when we let Him define us and our destinies and are surrendered completely to Him. This is the only way we can not only live purpose-filled lives but raise children and leave generations that will leave a mark in the world.



JOY DABIN

# HINDRANCE TO BIRTHING

Genesis 3:16

[16] Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children; and thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee.

From the fall of man, life was never again the same for the woman as the curse that Lord had declared upon her began to manifest in the birthing process. Birthing in this sense refers not only to the physical birthing of babies but also conception of ideas and thoughts.

The female folk suffers a lot of hindrances to birthing which includes; spiritual, emotional, psychological, physical and health hindrances to birthing.

In this article, we will be considering health hindrances to birthing with a specific focus on infertility. Infertility in females on a general note refers to the inability to give birth.

## MAJOR CAUSES OF INFERTILITY.

### 1.OVULATION DISORDERS

Ovulation disorders, meaning you ovulate infrequently or not at all, account for infertility in about 1 in 4 infertile couples. Problems with the regulation of reproductive hormones by the hypothalamus or the pituitary gland, or problems in the ovary, can cause ovulation disorders.

Polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS): PCOS causes a hormone imbalance, which affects ovulation. PCOS is associated with insulin resistance and obesity, abnormal hair growth on the face or body, and acne. It's the most common cause of female infertility.

Hypothalamic dysfunction: Two hormones produced by the pituitary gland are responsible for stimulating ovulation each month — follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH) and luteinizing hormone (LH). Excess physical or emotional stress, a very high or very low body weight, or a re-

cent substantial weight gain or loss can disrupt production of these hormones and affect ovulation. Irregular or absent periods are the most common signs. Premature ovarian failure: Also called primary ovarian insufficiency, this disorder is usually caused by an autoimmune response or by premature loss of eggs from your ovary (possibly from genetics or chemotherapy). The ovary no longer produces eggs, and it lowers estrogen production in women under the age of 40.

Too much prolactin. The pituitary gland may cause excess production of prolactin (hyperprolactinemia), which reduces estrogen production and may cause infertility. Usually related to a pituitary gland problem, this can also be caused by medications you're taking for another disease.

### 2.DAMAGE TO FALLOPIAN TUBES

Damaged or blocked fallopian tubes keep sperm from getting to the egg or block the passage of the fertilized egg into the uterus. Causes of fallopian tube damage or blockage can include:

Pelvic inflammatory disease, an infection of the uterus and fallopian tubes due to chlamydia, gonorrhea or other sexually transmitted infections. Previous surgery in the abdomen or pelvis, including surgery for ectopic pregnancy, in which a fertilized egg implants and develops in a fallopian tube instead of the uterus. Pelvic tuberculosis, a major cause of tubal infertility worldwide, although uncommon in the United States

### 3.ENDOMETRIOSIS

Endometriosis occurs when tissue that normally grows in the uterus implants and grows in other locations. This extra tissue growth and the surgical removal of it can cause scarring, which may block fallopian tubes and keep an egg and sperm from uniting. Endometriosis can also affect the lining of the uterus, disrupting implantation of the fertilized egg. The condition also seems to affect fertility in less-direct ways, such as damage to the sperm or egg.

### 4.UTERINE OR CERVICAL CAUSES

Several uterine or cervical causes can impact fertility by interfering with implantation or increasing the likelihood of a miscarriage: Benign polyps or tumors (fibroids or myomas) are common in the uterus. Some can block fallopian tubes or interfere with implantation, affecting fertility. However, many women who have fibroids



or polyps do become pregnant. Endometriosis scarring or inflammation within the uterus can disrupt implantation. Uterine abnormalities present from birth, such as an abnormally shaped uterus, can cause problems becoming or remaining pregnant. Cervical stenosis, a narrowing of the cervix, can be caused by an inherited malformation or damage to the cervix. Sometimes the cervix can't produce the best type of mucus to allow the sperm to travel through the cervix into the uterus.

### 5.UNEXPLAINED INFERTILITY

Sometimes, the cause of infertility is never found. A combination of several minor factors in both partners could cause unexplained fertility problems. Although it's frustrating to get no specific answer, this problem may correct itself with time. But, you shouldn't delay treatment for infertility.

### RISK FACTORS

Certain factors may put you at higher risk of infertility, including:  
Age: The quality and quantity of a woman's eggs begin to decline with

increasing age. In the mid-30s, the rate of follicle loss speeds, resulting in fewer and poorer quality eggs. This makes conception more difficult, and increases the risk of miscarriage. Smoking: Besides damaging your cervix and fallopian tubes, smoking increases your risk of miscarriage and ectopic pregnancy. It's also thought to age your ovaries and deplete your eggs prematurely. Stop smoking before beginning fertility treatment. Weight: Being overweight or significantly underweight may affect normal ovulation. Getting to a healthy body mass index (BMI) may increase the frequency of ovulation and likelihood of pregnancy.

Sexual history: Sexually transmitted infections such as chlamydia and gonorrhea can damage the fallopian tubes. Having unprotected intercourse with multiple partners increases your risk of a sexually transmitted infection that may cause fertility problems later.

Alcohol: Stick to moderate alcohol consumption of no more than one alcoholic drink per day.

## OLUWALEYE ADEDOYIN GRACE

# LETTER TO A SKIRT

Hey! Daughter of Eve,  
Mother of all,  
Most beautiful of all  
creatures,  
The earth goddess,  
Oh ye mortals, we  
deserve a crown made  
of precious stones.

☞ Daughter of Adam!  
How long will you toil the earth without a footprint?  
Like a ghost, thou leaves no trace,  
Need I remind you that you're born to make the earth  
leap?  
And rule the world with might and power and  
greatness.

☞ Woman!  
Rise! Let me tell you the tale of Ngozi Okonjoikeala,  
Sit and I'll tell you the story of chimmamanda,  
Have you heard the history of Dora Akunyili?  
Woman, listen and I'll tell you stories of great women  
who have penned their name a legend.

☞ I wish you a gift better than discrimination,  
Should I remind you that you're wired for greatness?  
You are a lion, roar!  
Walk through the hurdles on the mountain to its peak  
And command the universe.

☞ O ye daughter of Eve,  
They call you mothers of all  
Life giver to the little ones  
Ye should be mothers of greatness too  
Don't you think?

☞ Children of the dust, thou think we are birthed to  
bring life forth alone?  
We are birthed for greatness and victory and power,  
We are born fighters,  
We are woman  
Phenomenally.



# SEX IS BEAUTIFUL

Sex is like a garden when it's done in a right way, it becomes peaceful and colorful. In the garden we plant things together and they grow to become beautiful.

Sex plants actions that influence the thoughts, which in turn set in motion a reaction and response that I couldn't think of at first. Sex is powerful, it creates closeness and bond. It makes you love more and always want to be around your partner.

Sex is a soul tie, it allows your spirit to interact with the other person, allowing your body to move in unison with them. Sex is regarded as beautiful since it is the only natural activity that may stimulate you physically, emotionally, spiritually, and psychologically between two people. It is the most unique interaction created by God and He made it so beautiful.

A garden becomes ugly when planted on a swampy ground. A ground not good for cultivation. Sex done without the presence of the one who made it beautiful becomes dangerous and the only way to make His presence available is by two becoming one (Marriage) the highest institution created by God. God is the most beautiful person who has ever existed or will ever exist. All that is beautiful derives its beauty from him, and nothing that is beautiful is so apart from him.

The goal of sex is to form a deep friendship. It's all about clinging to the one God has given you. It's all about

being "one flesh." It's as though you're blending into one individual. The goal of sex is to achieve physical, emotional, sexual, and ontological oneness. It's all about surrender, exploration, discovery, and joy.

Sex becomes displeasing to God when it's done outside marriage. Sex outside marriage is sin. Sexual sins are potent relationship killers, not innocent dabbling in forbidden pleasures, as they are commonly described. They promote strife and destabilize the climate of respect, trust, and integrity that is essential for good marriages and secure children.



Don't it is powerful and it's a soul tie. It affects your spirit being which reflects to your physical being, if you have a sexual relationship with someone, you will take on some of their spirit, whether good or bad. The more sexual relationships you have, the more a piece of each person remains with you, and portions of yourself become a part of them. So, even though the sexual relationship is only temporary, the soul bond is permanent. This is why God made it sacred for marriage. Sex outside marriage can lead to destruction of one's destiny. Wait to experience the beauty of sex in marriage.

# SELFNESS



■ I love the woman called RUTH.

## Her Story Gave

■ us a clear view of what contentment is all about.

A widow with no child or hope or having any, yet became contented with who she is. In the state where her mother-in-law asked her to leave and find a better life. Ruth having the understanding of her place in the life of Naomi, her God given place, her place of fulfilment and she decided not to leave. Ruth could have been swayed by her doubts and inquiries to leave Naomi. Her heart, on the other hand, came to terms with what she thought. She transitioned from the agony of unanswerable questions to the reality of unavoidable answers. She had a strong feeling that she needed to stay with Naomi. And she acted on her conviction. Great deeds are preceded by strong convictions. We need to follow through when we feel something is right and our conviction is enhanced by the

knowledge that our motives are pure, as Ruth's were. Others may question our reasoning and decision-making. But we can't let those things stop us from doing what we know is right. We must stand firm in our beliefs.

Indeed, she have every right to leave and start a new life, she has every right to go out there and husband hunt, she has every right to enjoy her singleness again instead of living as a widow in the house of Naomi. The truth remains that Ruth did not see her life outside the life of Naomi as a daughter-in-law. It was her God-given assignment. Oh Oprah is gone. She is wise enough to leave instead of living as a young widow. Life demands more than we can think. I know most of us will jump unto the decision Oprah took.

As a result of Ruth following her heart and joining Naomi to Bethlehem, Ruth's influence rose. Rather than discarding her as a stranger, the Hebrews admired and respected her. "I've heard everything about you," Boaz told her, "about the way you treated your mother-in-law after her husband died, and how you abandoned your father and mother and the land of your birth to live

among a group of complete strangers." GOD will lavishly reward you for everything you've accomplished, as well as a large bonus from GOD, to whom you've come seeking refuge under his wings." Ruth went from being a foreigner to being respected, blessed, and honored by following her heart and doing what she knew was right. Your self-potentials increase when you follow your heart and do the right thing in God. The situation you see yourself today does not make it the end of the world but the beginning of your testimony.



# HER:

One day,  
The world will see us as we are  
Bare creatures  
Longing for our creator's love  
Neither black nor white  
We will be seen as Beings that were called  
"alone" till a rib pulled from us became the  
flesh of our flesh and we found a compan-  
ionship in the presence of her.

And this rib you will remember.  
You will remember her by her words,  
Sharper than the samurai's blade, they cut  
through your soul vanquishing dead things.  
You will remember her body, how she car-  
ried it with grace and royalty became the  
only words that fitted the aura her very  
presence let out when she walks.  
You will remember her eyes, the stare that  
looks deeply into your soul, it leaves you in  
awe on how God could create such a per-  
fect replica of what the word grace should  
be in person.

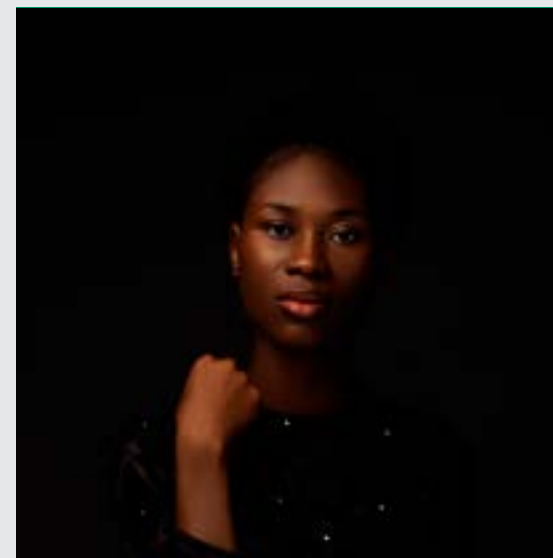
Today.  
She Let the world see the sweetness she  
carries  
Like honey dripping from its jar;  
She Let her happiness flow and sweeten the  
lives of those around.  
Her very existence replicates life.  
Not just a vessel carrying the mandate of  
procreation,  
Her life completes yours.  
It fits so perfectly, shaping out the excesses  
of your weaknesses.

Her very existence replicates life  
You are reminded of your creator's love,  
No longer are you bare,  
She reminds you of your creator's love.

**ENE OGABA**



## A NEW APPROACH TO IMPROVE SELF ESTEEM AND A POSITIVE MENTAL HEALTH.



From time immemorial there have been discussions all over the globe on how individuals suffering from low self-esteem, mental health illnesses can find their true self and begin to live. They've been told to change their mentality, speak up, master their emotions and do some other helpful and interesting stuff that is aimed at helping them, but with all these suggestions are series of individuals battling to stay afloat, find themselves, and survive through each day, some still go as far as committing suicide and those who don't live with pains from confusions that make them wish they could die.

While these tips are important, it is also paramount that we fix a major area that seems like a bedrock for these issues, and that is our environment. Let our homes, worship centers, schools, market places, and every other gathering become open to these individuals, let an inclusive society be made available to them. Just as it is impossible to kill a fish in water, it is also impossible to get a man to heal in an environment that is demeaning.

Let's relate with them, involve them in activities, speak softly to them, let them know they are part of a system that cares, and maybe the healing process will become faster. When a child begins to stay away from others, involve him wisely and calmly, when the other stays crying, and constantly snaps in and out of mood, reach out kindly and patiently. One little help at a time can bring a transformation that years of speech presentation might not.

We have all been called to live, and bear fruits, no one deserves to stay stuck in themselves, every seed of greatness needs to find expression as well. Let's join our hands together and create a society that not only preaches wholeness but creates an atmosphere for becoming whole.

Regards,

MERCY AJEH.

## WHAT DEFINES HER

A woman of vision is a woman of favor. A woman of prayer is a woman that touches the heart of heaven. A woman of vision is a woman of greatness. It doesn't matter who hates or what society thinks about you. You are focused on the path to secure your seed, allowing it to be watered by your creator to become a great seed to the generation.

A woman of vision understands that there is no limit to her greatness. She attracts good fortune just as Esther. A woman of divine favor has a divine fragrance. You become the preferred choice. You do not have to run after those material things because wealth becomes yours, they come at your feet.

A great woman delivers God's divine purpose to her generation. She is one who understands her role and mission to the society. They are productive and contribute to positive changes in the society. She is a woman who cares for other and she cares for her child.

Her character counts to her destiny and in her glory, beauty is found. The sweet heart of a woman makes her environment feel the pelting streaks of rain in a summer shower.

## THE WOMAN'S PLACE IN THE HEART OF GOD A SOLUTION

### Ada Nwosu

Before the creation of a woman, the lord first of all saw the loneliness of man, and decided to make a woman. The loneliness that man had was not one that even God could fill, God had a deficiency in occupying the loneliness that Adam felt, and you notice that he didn't say oh Adam needs more power, or more of God's presence but he saw that what man needed was a woman and not even animals could occupy that space, there was virtually nothing present upon the earth to occupy that space. For God to have taken note of it, it means that it was going to be a threat to the relationship that man had with God, then the lord said it is not good for man to be alone. Therefore, he created a woman and the place of a woman in the heart of God is that she becomes a solution.

What is a solution? something that is used or done to deal with and end a problem: something that solves a problem. Synonymously, it is called an answer.

God made the woman as a solution; she was not made because God had a good day but because there was a need, hence, she was made to solve problems, she was made to be a blessing, when you solve problems, you become a blessing.

Inside every woman is a solution, she is not a solution to the earth alone but also to the burdens of God. If we all as women would understand this, we can and would shake the world. Eve fell because she did not understand her place and she didn't understand her place because she did not ask God some questions like who am I, what am I called to do? What is my place in creation, what do you see in me, instead she believed the serpent who told her a misplaced truth?

Woman you are special, you are a solution, you have your place both in God and man. When relating with any human upon the face of the earth know of a truth where you stand in the creative agenda of God, it's in this place that you can be useful upon the earth to be a blessing to both God and man.

# LIVING THE DREAMS

There's so much joy that comes with the birth of a female child. Truly so. Every girl is indeed a unique being, and a huge blessing to the society at large. Most young girls seem to understand the depth and reason for their existence early enough. Many thanks to parents and guardians who do an amazing job at raising the girl child. While this is true, for some other girls, their experience is not the same.

Certain factors are responsible for this; some are self-inflicted while others are influenced by the environment. If it's okay to take a mental trip with me to the first time you began to understand the importance of life and the activities of life. I am sure this phase of your life got flooded with aspirations and statements like "when I grow up I will..."

Do you remember there were a number of things you promised yourself when you were growing up? Can you remember those aspirations? So, the question is, what happened to those dreams? It is either you stopped growing or you stopped dreaming. Like I said earlier, certain factors are actually responsible for not being productive or living your dreams.

## THE GIRL CALLED YOU.

Yes, you. Most young girls are growing out of who they should be and are becoming more of who they shouldn't. I believe, change is a constant in life, but growth is a very intentional process.

The Puberty stage comes with a lot of changes, and unfortunately, most girls are not able to deal with it. As a result, they allow themselves to be tossed around by emotions. Feeling all grown up and complacent, sometimes, takes you away from your goals and dreams. It makes you settle for less than you ought to have.

## ENVIRONMENT AND RELATIONSHIP

It is important to know that achieving great dreams is partly determined by the kind of friends you keep. We are often influenced by what we see, hear and feel. And these three things can be fed by the environment and the quality of people around us.

## BASIC TOOLS TO BECOMING PRODUCTIVE.

1. Understand who you are. One of the major mistakes youngest girls make is a lack of understanding of their identity. It's okay to have role models and mentors, but the goal is not to become like them, but to learn from their stories and apply the lessons and wisdom you glean in the process. You don't have to aspire to be like anyone else. When you aspire to be like everyone else, it is a sign that you are not yet aware of who you are and your own capacity. You end up being a second fiddle each time you try to be like someone else. You have only you to become because every other person is taken.

2. Discover your WHY. This refers to the reason you have been made the person you are. Why exactly were born into your family? Why are you a girl? Asking the right questions will produce the right answers.

3. Get Education. Education can be formal or informal, but the most important thing is that you're getting your mind expanded. Open up to trainings, pay attention to your studies. This opens you up to a new world of possibilities.

4. Get your hands and not your back dirty. Getting your hands dirty speaks to your productivity; you engaging your hands and your creative mind to do great things. Get your hands. Female qualities are often seen as a mode of exchange by pedophiles, and most girls are blindly going with this. Trying to fit the stereotype. You can achieve all that you set your mind to.

5. Practice daily routines. Whatever you do consistently becomes a part of you. Self-discipline is key in being productive. What positive habits have you imbibed? Your habits make you.

6. Believe in yourself. It's important for you to always believe that you have all it takes to succeed. Life has a way of making you feel like you're empty, but you're not. You start making mistakes and doubting yourself when you make it another person's duty to do the believing for you. Any one that believes on your behalf has the capacity to control your results or level of productivity. Trust yourself enough and believe in yourself.

■ I believe that you have all it takes to be a productive young lady. The centre stage waits you. YES, YOU CAN. FLORENCE KARL-OGWU. Family Therapist.





# CALLED TO DO HARD THINGS

BY LIV DOOLEY

Sometimes, Jesus calls us to do hard things. If the truth is told, they don't always seem hard to others, but they are, nonetheless. One of the hardest things I've felt God asking me to do to date is to host mother daughter events. At first glance, it doesn't really seem hard, does it? Well, in order to sense the difficulty of this call, you'd have to understand that I don't have a daughter, and I would love to be a mama to a little baby girl. That's why every now and then, I get a little sad and even feel a little bit like an imposter, attempting to encourage mamas and daughters from the one sided perspective as daughter. Still, it's what He's called me to do and He strengthens and equips me for it every time. I know He'll do the same for you.

At the time that I'm writing this, my husband and I have been to countless fertility appointments in an attempt to get closer to the dream of beginning a family, and they have yet to be successful. In fact, they're downright disappointing at this moment. Why? Because I know I've been born to birth a little girl whose name I already have on the tip of my tongue. I'm just waiting to call it out and see a smile light up across her face. This past summer, my husband and I passed on countless amazing opportunities in an effort to save for our future family. One of the hardest days I endured was seeing all of the pictures of my family at a wedding. That was the day I received the call to tell me that the pregnancy test was negative, and it felt really hard to hold my head up. Missing the wedding would have been easier if I'd have been pregnant, but God had other plans because sometimes He calls us to do hard things. What's the one thing He charged me with this past summer? Hosting an online prayer challenge for, you guessed it, mamas, mentors, and daughters. Again, I repeat, sometimes God calls us to do hard things. We were born to birth, and, thankfully, goodness and mercy pursue us ensuring that we fulfill our purpose in this earth. There are others who are waiting on the other side of our obedience!

Regardless of if we're called to motherhood in the natural sense or not, I want to encourage you to remember that you have been born to birth. You have been born to birth love, peace, joy, hope, patience, goodness, kindness, faithfulness, perseverance, restoration, and favor in the world, among so many other good things. And surprise!!! We have to travail for it. We have to cry about it. We have to endure the pain of bringing it into this world, but when we do,

it is one of the most fulfilling, most rewarding opportunities we will ever have. And we know it. Prayer is the one place we have the opportunity to birth new things into the world on a never ending basis. It has no limits. Prayer is the place where we release new blessings that will never die. Yep, that's right. They'll outlive you. They'll serve as your legacy. They'll lead others to remember you long after they've forgotten your name.

The word tells us- "As the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts than your thoughts" in Isaiah 55:9, and it shows us that we won't always understand God's ways or thoughts. It's why I'm grateful for prayer. When we pray, we walk away with a new perspective-a Godly perspective-a perspective fixed on Heaven. When we pray, we stop looking at ourselves and we start looking at our God. When we pray, we find His peace and His power to do hard things unlike anything we ever believed ourselves capable of-regardless of how other people see them.

It's true that prayer is communication with God. It's that time and space where He listens to our every word, interprets our every thought, and reads every twist of our necks and flutter of our hands and hearts. It's the time we spend listening to Him, reading His love letter (our Bible), and getting to know Him and His will for ourselves and our world. Prayer can be really simple at times, but it is as big, powerful, and miraculous as it is simple. I like to say that prayer is the choice to take ownership of your faith and actively participate in the partnership offered by our Holy God, the Great I Am, Jesus Christ. Matthew 18:18 instructs us further when Jesus said,

"Truly I tell you, whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven." What is that, if not an opportunity to own and activate your faith in partnership with Jesus by binding (forbidding) those things you see attempting to develop a stronghold in the world and loosing (releasing) those things God gives you a revelation of through prayer so that we can see Heaven touch earth? Unfortunately, (or fortunately, depending upon how you look at it), that means you're going to travail, cry, get desperate, lose your voice, and feel like sleep is evading you at times, just like a woman in labor. Just know that on the other side of that, you'll have your own little piece of Heaven.

Today, I want to ask you to open your heart and invite God to show you what He wants you to birth in the world. It may come at the expense of a dream you've had in your heart for years now. It may come at the expense of a little sleep. It may come at the expense of the time you would normally spend praying for yourself and your people, but when we choose to humble ourselves it's worth it every time. Remember, not only does our great God know best, but He wants to partner with us. Push past the momentary pain and discomfort to encounter Him in a new way. After all, can you believe that the same God who spoke with Moses, Deborah, Samuel, David, Elijah, Esther, Peter, Mary Magdalene, and Paul wants to listen and speak to us? Can you believe that He wants to use us to accomplish His will? Keep your eyes on Jesus and watch Him satisfy you as He speaks to the purpose within you. He will expand your capacity to birth greatness into the world beyond your wildest imaginations. Trust Him.

However, as it is written: "What no eye has seen, what no ear has heard, and what no human mind has conceived" — the things God has prepared for those who love him—these are the things God has revealed to us by his Spirit. The Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God.

-First Corinthians 2:10

Heavenly Father, we agree with what heaven is speaking about everything You have to pour out from Your heart into this world. We want to stand in the midst of Your outpouring, Holy Spirit. We want to feel Your presence and behold Your beauty. We want to see You, King Jesus. Give us Your perspective and help us walk in gratitude, with a heightened awareness about what we've been called to birth today, in your precious name, Jesus, we pray, amen.

Love you,

Liv

You can find more about Liv Dooley on Instagram at @candidliv or her website candidliv.com. Please subscribe to The Best Kept Secret with Liv Dooley on iTunes or Spotify to receive audible inspiration, as well.



# THE JOURNEY TO BIRTHING



The journey to birthing is the cultivation period of your life. It is the most painful and tempting period that leads you to giving up. A cultivated ground gives you a fertile soil. A fertile soil is a soil that is able to produce plant. It is a soil that is able to produce or yield fruits. It is a soil that carries the existence of life. Everyone is a soil but not all soil is fertile. Some soils lack manure, some lack sunlight and while some lack water. A fertile ground can grow as many seeds as it wants to grow.

Understanding your ground make you know the kind of seed you should plant on it. Life is all about self-discovery. As a woman, you are seed carrier, a generation carrier. The kind of generation you will produce depends on what seed you plants and nurtures. Woman! you have the power to create, the womb made you a creator. Your purpose in life births generations and destines.

It all starts from you finding yourself, getting your manure (value), allowing yourself to be watered and receiving the right source of light that your seed will grow and

# PRESERVING THE NEXT GENERATION

Apart from waking up early in the morning to fix the daily chores and staying up late most nights to keep our to-do list crossed, we have a lot more to do as women. In paying attention to the tiny details of our children's homework and ensuring we keep to date with their school parties and outdoor games, it's a lot of responsibility wrapped up in love. And whether you are a single mother, a mother of four, married or a lady in waiting the responsibility of birthing the next generation stares before us like as child seeking help.

Our children will be malnourished, faint and incapable of facing the rashness life will throw at them, they will not be able to defend faith, stand in the face of oppositions, and regardless of the storms and bait determine to move forward, do we groom weaklings? No mother ever wants to do that.

The Princess of Egypt had seen such a fair baby to look upon. He was neatly wrapped and placed inside a basket made of papyrus reeds, where fate lies. Moses was that baby, the famous Israel's leader who was said to be the meekest man on earth in his time; had grown with so much influence and had favor with both God and Man, yet destiny laid among the reeds along the Nile River and it will either be preserved or would naturally be destroyed.

Three key persons played an undaunted role in ensuring that Moses had a common and nurtured life which set him in the path of destiny fulfilment. The first is Miriam, Miriam was Moses earthly elder sister, while Moses was somewhere in the river wrapped in the basket, Miriam was on a look out, she was observant and not oblivion of the events that took place where Moses laid such that when the Princess, Pharaoh's daughter noticed the baby and asked that the baby be brought to her, Miriam noticed the compassion that the Princess had for the child, she took the step and approached the Princess asking if she could seek for the Princess a nurse who would nourish her new found baby.

Miriam undeniably, played an outstanding role in preserving the life and destiny of Moses, Israel's astute leader. She served as the watchman, looking out to take the needed action that will help preserve the life and by implication the destiny of her kid brother.

Now, how does this relate to us as women, ladies and sisters of this generation, the 21st century women, my simple question will help me relate this; Who are we on a look out for? Who and who's destinies are we seeking to preserve? Both in the place of prayers of intercession, and giving out good counsel. Our Moses's are everywhere and we do not need to be their biological mother to preserve them, they are in the classrooms where we teach, they are in the yards where we own our shops, in the hoods where we live, they are everywhere and our duty just like Miriam did is to be on a look out for them and seek to preserve the destinies of these our kid siblings whom the enemy doesn't want alive.

The next person that played a vital role in the life of Moses was the biological mother of Moses, Jochebed. Jochebed diligently nurtured the baby soon to be leader and deliverer of Israel, how would she had known that the baby she bathed and fed each day would one day become Israel's hero, yet she served her part in influencing, teaching and nurturing the young boy. We as mother's, have the grace's for this responsibility, we are first of all given the responsibility to nurture and we do that every day as we cook the meals, prepare the children, make the beds,

our attitude towards doing these things will be greatly influenced when we understand that we are nurturing Kings and great leaders of the next generation, we will be more concerned about how much we have been able to influence them and teach them about God and the principles that will help them stay strong through life, and yes! Even after we leave the earth. Something about Momma's prayer while they are fast asleep in their rooms, or momma's advice, momma's tenderness and love keeps this next generation's hero's and heroine going through the storm. And this is applicable whether for our male or female children.

## NEXT GENERATION

Then, the daughter of Pharaoh, the princess, the lady who looked upon the baby with so much compassion that she needed a good life for the baby Moses, she reasoned that assigning the baby to a nurse was a good idea, even if she perhaps didn't have all it takes to groom him, she saw the need to hand him over to a nurse who would tend the child. She took the initiative to send for the child and reached out to him. We may not have all that we need to care of this children, maybe not all the skills, education, money, tenacity, but taking the step to reach out to the young ones around us and within our care, reaching out to them with the word of life and introducing to them to the person of the Holy Spirit who will nourish them and guide them into all truth is something all of us can be a part of as women.

Whether we are mothers, sisters, friends, neighbors, teachers, acquaintances, if we desire to birth and preserve a next generation which we would sit back and be proud of, if we want to raise a generation that will uphold values and preserve truth, we will have to play our part while we have the opportunity to influence the young ones is before us, so that we can be proud of the generation that will come after us -the next generation

## Esther Archibong



# IS THERE ANYTHING MORE REAL THAN HELL OR HEAVEN?

ANYAFULU THELMA ISIOMA I



Just for a slight peak into how my life used to be before we dive into the topic, I grew up amongst children belonging to my neighbors and amongst my siblings also, I started at a very tender age, let's say 7 years of age. I got curious about sex, kissing and all. Those times, I was ignorant. I loved to act drama where I could kiss whether it was a boy or a girl mattered not at least to me. The curiosity developed into adolescent and teenage years, I loved claiming to be older in age so that older guys won't see me this inexperienced. I got introduced to porn at the age of 11 years by the way so I grew in quest to satisfy my lustful desire; when I felt good for the first time, I desired more and more until it became miserable. I had gotten addicted to pornography, all kinds of pornography be it lesbianism, rape, incest, anime and the list goes on and on. All these amounted to little satisfaction; I was forced to try it out by seeking a lesbian partner even though it only worked for a night because I was left irritated with the act and less interested.

When I finally encountered God, I gave my life to Christ but that did not save me. Every time, I backslided. Sin waited for me with a wide hug, I grew worse, I got into reading erotic novels even tried although to a failed attempt to touch myself by way of arousing myself and masturbating, I grew curious as to why people enjoyed it and I could not until I recovered again and would weep praying, pleading with God to help me out of it all not until I finally knew experientially the act of sex with different sexual partners under the cover of "dating". But then God helped me to understand his love for me this doesn't mean I became perfect certainly no! Neither do I write

on the steps to overcoming addictions but I intend to share what has helped me from the very start of my walk with Christ until today. It is my earnest prayer that the ever gracious Jesus takes your hand in alignment to your submission to him and leads you into such realities.

Heaven is real and so is hell, but the irony of life is that many of us do not pay full attention the scorching heat that emits from the furnace of fire; we seem to be real and we fear ever going through that door that leads to damnation for as eternity lasts. Yet many of us, even while we believe such existence still crave for a taste of the pleasures of this world it's more of the deceit we often tell ourselves "we only live once", many have a zeal for the knowledge of God but are unfortunate in their search because they sought the wrong way, same way many are 'lovers of God' every Sunday and it is their sincere desire to be real Christians but like the Israelite in return get sin slaved through the rest of the week. Thus, it's appropriate to speak in the word of Apostle Paul in Romans 7:22-23 and verse 15 respectively; "For I delight in the law of God after the inward man: But I see another law in my members, warring against the law of my mind and bringing me into captivity to the law of sin which is in my members O wretched man that I am! Who shall deliver me from the body of this death?"

Verse 15 earlier spoke:

"For that, which I do, I allow not; for that I would that do I not; but what I hate that do I"

Many a times we find we find ourselves drawn to a stronger

addiction in our lives for instance stealing, lying, backbiting, unforgiveness, hatred, lasciviousness, all forms of sexual immoralities and the list goes on and on.... We find ourselves enticed to worldly things that causes to sin whether intentionally or not; this contradicts our desire to please God but the end result is that we yield back to that sinful life (there's no such thing as a major or minor sin truthfully speaking, Sin is Sin no matter the form or shape.): Romans 6:16 says:

Know ye not, that to ye yield yourselves servants to obey, his servants ye are to whom ye obey; whether of sin unto death, or of obedience unto righteousness?" Why then do we keep on falling prey to these sinful addictions? Is it just only because we yield our members to sin so easily or is it because our resolutions were not firm enough or that we are walking under a curse like some people put it: "you're being controlled by some kingdom of darkness" or is just majorly on the part that we don't watch & pray consciously or that we are being noticed daily by the devil as his targets? As much as we seek an excuse to form the basis of why we sin repeatedly, neither of these assumptions is correct as the bible puts it this way in Romans 5:13-19:

Therefore, just as sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin, and in this way death came to all people, because all sinned—

To be sure, sin was in the world before the law was given, but sin is not charged against anyone's account where there is no law. 14 Nevertheless, death reigned from the time of Adam to the time of Moses, even over those who did not sin by breaking a command, as did Adam, who is a pattern of the one to come.

17 For if, by the trespass of the one man, death reigned through that one man, how much more will those who receive God's abundant provision of grace and of the gift of righteousness reign in life through the one man, Jesus Christ!

19 For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous.

We became bound to sin in that, we could not please God no matter how hard we tried or how soberly we walked 'for ALL have sinned and has fallen short of His glory' the devil so programmed his schemes in such a way that A.W Tozer puts it and I can't agree less; he says it as "he

gives you the pleasures of the earth that makes you want the treasures of the earth" he keeps enticing you and little by little you desire more of what he gives. I made an illustration sometime while talking on enticement and I can't but share it to readers here or where such opportunity is found;

As a babe you desired the milk of a lactating mother, and you were fed overtime, you moved to baby foods and you grew up taking soft foods but now you're all grown up with your teeth strong to masticate all kinds of food surely, you can't as a grown up desire those things of the former any longer as it doesn't conform to your growth stage, so it is with the enticement the devil throws at us daily, we get driven by a taste after another and another until it is too late to recover or even until our lust for worldly things drive us completely out of the presence of God into the open arms of sin.

Understanding the love of God whether as in a person of Jesus Christ or as to the finished work on the cross; I may not have so much knowledge or experience but this one thing I'm certain of that Jesus Christ is real as the next visible person, that he loves you ENDLESSLY. It is not a story that He died on the cross neither is it fake that once you believe in him, confess him as Christ and Lord over you, you are saved and welcomed into his beloved.

The fear you have of hell and eagerness you have towards making heaven cannot and will never surpass the pleasure of knowing, understanding and experiencing the love of God towards you. The devil makes us most times to question God's love for us and we forced to look carnally at the circumstances surrounding us...this often has driven me to attempt suicide severally in my life as I always got fed up with my life whilst the enemy kept whispering lies into my itching ears that I refused to see clearly through God's word spoken already before the foundations of the world concerning me but God kept snatching me out, I grew angry severally to the extent of calling God accursed! I intentionally had indulge severally in immoralities just that I may prove to God that I cared nothing about him or his desires for my life but God walked in always, interrupting my life while I had just about to get fed up with

breathing. The image God painted for me was found in the book Ezekiel 16:8-13(I advice you study it personally) this scripture has not only made me believe, it created a means in which God could permeate over my heart.

Before I conclude, if there is something worth finding and experiencing it would certainly be the love of God towards you: this goes beyond knowledge of the bible, it is something beautiful and glorious to behold! It is, knowing and comprehending the breath, length, depth and height of God's love displayed through Christ's death on the cross and being rooted and grounded in his love. It was the love of God that changed me of all my ways and washed me of all my stains making me a legitimate Christ of God! It was not my parents, pastor, teacher or society; all these made me nothing more than a moralist who strived for mastery. I can't unfold the vastness of this love as it entails knowing DAILY the person Jesus was and still is but I can only point the direction you can take to starting this journey and that is: When you hear his voice do not harden your heart, Jesus has been speaking to you severally in your heart, school, television, church, on the road name it all; it is not new that you heard "give your life to Christ and it definitely does not matter how it as presented to you, here it is again:

ACCEPT THE LIFE OF CHRIST!

How do you accept the life of Christ? Romans 10:10(for with the heart man believeth unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation)

It doesn't matter what you look like, what you've done in the past or do in the present Jesus is ENDLESSLY in love with who you are and he needs no man's recommendation to love you the way he does all you have to do is just 'COME'. Lo, he calls you 'come to me all who labor and are heavily laden and I will give you rest (from all things and in all things) come casting all your cares on me, I care about you!

Give him an answer today, don't keep him waiting!

Thank you for your time.

## IS THERE ANYTHING MORE REAL THAN HELL OR HEAVEN? (Cont.)

The fear you have of hell and eagerness you have towards making heaven cannot and will never surpass the pleasure of knowing, understanding and experiencing the love of God towards you. The devil makes us most times to question God's love for us and we forced to look carnally at the circumstances surrounding us...this often has driven me to attempt suicide thrice in my life but God kept snatching out of it, I grew angry curse God even! Intentionally had several sexual immoralities just so I could prove to God that I cared nothing about him or his desires for my life but God walked in severally interrupting my life while I had just about to get fed up with breathing. The image God painted for me was found in the book Ezekiel 16:8-13(I advice you study it personally) this scripture has not only made me believe, it created a means in which God could permeate over my heart.

Before I conclude, if there is something worth finding and experience it would be the love of God for you personally this goes beyond knowledge of the bible, it is something beautiful and glorious to behold is knowing the breath and length, depth and height love of God in Christ Jesus and being rooted and grounded in his love. It was the love of God that changed me of all my ways, not my parents, pastor, teacher or society; all these made me nothing more than a moralist who striving for mastery. I can't unfold the vastness of this love as it entails knowing DAILY the person Jesus was and still is but I can only point the direction you can take to starting this journey and that is: When you hear his voice do not harden your heart, Jesus has been speaking to you severally in your heart, school, television, church, on the road name it all; it is not new that you heard "give your life to Christ and it definitely does not matter how it as presented to you, here it is again:

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Thank you for your time.



## FLAWED STATE OF NIGERIA SPORTS.

### NIGERIA SPORTS



When it seemed like sports is the only thing that unite us as a nation, our mediocre leaders have failed the nation again. Be it football, athletics or any other sporting events involving us (Nigeria) as a nation. Sports usually has a way of taking away our attention from everyday hustles and struggles we go through as a nation. Recently it has been a nightmare for lovers of sports as it regards sporting events in general. From the failures of both the male and the female national teams to qualify for Tokyo Olympics soccer events, to unpaid allowances own to athletes and to the deplorable state of sporting facilities in the country.



currently taking place in Tokyo japan. It was expected that a nation as big as Nigeria; with over 180 million people in terms of population would make a good representation with the pool of talents they are endowed with. In fighting from various sports federations over electoral positions, to inadequate preparations for major sporting events. This has been the challenges that hamper successful participation in global sports. Recently, a huge scandal hit team Nigeria camp at the ongoing Tokyo 2020 Olympics games when 10 Nigeria athletes were disqualified from competing in the event after they failed to undergo mandatory tests ahead of the global sports event. The Nigeria camp was thrown into a mourning mood, after news filtered that the athletes to compete in track and field events, had been sent packing from the games with

just two days to the start of athletics events. This was basically possible when Nigeria and others countries were upgraded to category a country. The category a countries are countries with high chances of failing doping tests as stated by the A.I.U (athletics integrity unit). The athletics integrity units disclosed that a total of 20 athletes across the world were disqualified (of which 10 athletes are from Nigeria). One will even ask the once at the top what it takes for these disqualified athletes to undergo this mandatory tests ahead of the global sports event, knowing quite well that the tests is a must for all category a countries participating in the global event or is it that somebody somewhere is not doing his/her job? From the checks in the Nigeria camp, the relay team has been mostly affected. By this, limiting Nigeria

chances of making it to the podium athletics wise. All the staying up and staying glued to our televisions waiting for the Nigeria contingents to take the center stage during the colorful opening ceremony in Tokyo japan. They never met the expectations of the teeming sports fan; especially athletics fans of Nigeria origin. With this disqualification saga, Nigerians will forever hold this against our so called leaders that have failed us in everything.

The truth is that sport system in Nigeria is flawed and the athletes are always at the receiving end of the damages. Those who are not passionate about the sport, passionate about the wellbeing of the athletes and don't know the sport, should not handle the administrative positions period.

KINGSLEY OKWO

# BORN TO BIRTH CHRISTIANS

**Hi, My name is IBKinx and I'd like to tell you a story, a very relatable story.**

**A story about the cycle of life.**



As a child when we are born the natural progression is to grow, and at some point give birth to other children, right? That way, we can say one of our purposes is being born to birth.

That's one point. We can back it up with evidence of this purpose found in Genesis 1:28.

Genesis 1:28 "God blessed them and said to them, "Be fruitful and increase in number; fill the earth and subdue it. Rule over the fishes in the sea, and the birds in the sky and over every living creature that moves on the ground." Then the second point is. As Christians, we don't have any kind of birth. We are supposed to birth in Gods image because that's how we came. Genesis 1:27.

Genesis 1:27: "So God created man in his image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them."

But how can we do this? Point 3. As Christians, we need to recognise that birthing is beyond physical, It is spiritual too. We need to create more of us by preaching to the world Mark 16 vs 15.

Mark 16:15: "And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature."

By doing this, we are exercising our spiritual purpose of being born to birth.

Point 4: but it's never easy. Jesus himself needed help to fulfil this purpose while on earth.

Matthew 4:19: "Come, follow me," Jesus said, "and I will send you out to fish for people."

So how can we do the same with our numerous commitments?

1

Point 5. There are so many methods of sharing God's word daily. Here are a few:

1. After deciding to share the gospel, Read and Study the Bible as often as possible. I recommend that Christians study the word of God daily. To obey Gods instruction on sharing the gospel, we have to know the word, to share it. We should also pray earnestly for Gods help every time we intend to

share Gods word. Preaching the good news of Christ is ALL about God and not about us.

2. Let your light shine before men so that they see your good works. Matthew 5:14-16

"You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden. 15 Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead, they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. 16 In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven." At our jobs, homes, everywhere we find ourselves, our actions, our speech, let people see God in you, let them be drawn to God through you. After all, we were made in His image. When they question what makes us who we are, we don't hide behind zodiac signs or genetics but under God. That question becomes a valid opportunity to share the gospel with the person.

3. As you share your lives on social media, prioritise Gods word on there too. It may start from quoting verses or sharing testimonies and relating them to Gods word. This gesture may lead people to Christ. I'd recommend starting with a bible verse that speaks to you from your daily devotion to interacting with polls. No matter how little the interaction is, always remember Luke 15:7,

"I tell you that in the same way, there will be more rejoicing in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent."

4. Using gospel quote stickers is a subtle way to share God's word. Biblical quote stickers could be placed on home doors, your car, bumper sticker, your workstation at the office, your PC, clothing, jewellery, phone cover, keychain, bag buttons, etc. Not only do these speak to others who come across your signs, but the signs also speak to you too. Deuteronomy 11:18

"You shall therefore lay up these words of mine in your heart and in your soul, and you shall bind them as a sign on your hand, and they shall be as frontlets between your eyes."

2

Proverbs 3:3

"Let not steadfast love and faithfulness forsake you; bind them around your neck; write them on the tablet of your heart.

Proverbs 6:21

"Bind them on your heart always; tie them around your neck."

Proverbs 7:3

"bind them on your fingers; write them on the tablet of your heart."

Point 6: You might be thinking: "what If I can't do all these. It's quite hard you know".

Now let's remember Mark 16:16.

"He that believeth and is baptised shall be saved, but he that believeth not shall be damned."

Those people we don't preach to might have it harder if they are damned. Best to preach to them. Encourage yourself and show how taking care of Gods birthing purpose produces lovely outcomes from adorable offspring to incredible blessings

Matthew 6:33

"But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well."

In conclusion, it is with the love of God that I hope that from today we start obeying God's instruction to preach Gods word every day in one way or more. As always, may the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, the love of God, and the sweet fellowship of the Holy Spirit, be with us now and evermore, Amen.

Shalom,

Blessing (IBKinx), 2021





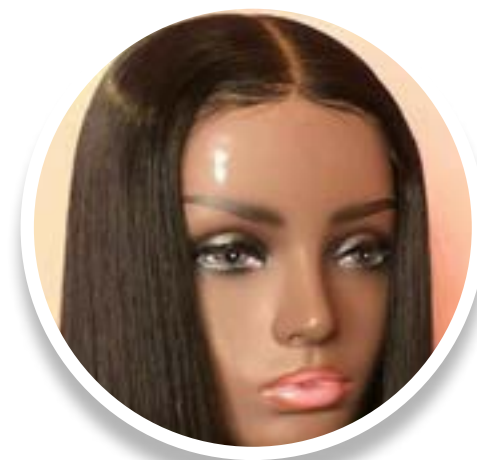
# Yetzy

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